The Late Market — Project Budget

Milestone-aware budget for the Zoud GameLab entry (Nov 15, 2026) · prepared for the development-funding criteria · Udi Robert

1 · Summary

Line	Spent / committed	Planned (remaining)
ElevenLabs Starter (voices, music, SFX, commercial licence)	$6.00 (Nov 2026 subscription)	$0 (re-bakes use included credits)
Voice line bakes (41 lines, Nov 10) + jam re-bake (~20 changed lines)	$0 (subscription credits)	$0 (subscription credits)
Cover art (630×500, AI-generated, disclosed on itch)	$0–10	$0–10
Hosting (itch.io free HTML5 hosting)	$0	$0
Contract illustration (option, NOT exercised — all art in-house SVG/pixel)	$0	$0
Total	**≤ $16**	**≤ $26**

Ceiling check: the GDD budget band is $15–500 depending on illustration. The jam build stayed at the floor — every visual is hand-coded SVG/pixel art (the three stallholders, the stall screen, the street), so the contract-illustration option (~$300–450) was not needed. Worst-case total if the option were exercised later: ≤ $500.

2 · What the budget bought (receipts)

Item	Detail	Cost
ElevenLabs Starter	1 month, Nov 2026 · 30k credits · commercial licence · two persistent voices (Siki/Zana) + pronunciation dictionary pinned at bake time	$6.00
Voice bakes	41 lines on eleven_v4 with char-level alignment (Nov 10); jam re-bake covers the rebuilt Chapter 1 (~20 lines, ≈1,400 chars) — within included credits, no per-API billing	$0
SFX + ambience	market ambience loop, music bed, four foley one-shots, speaker stingers — pre-baked, subscription credits	$0

Cover	one 630×500 illustration, AI-generated (tool named in the itch.io AI disclosure)	$0–10

Voice model economics (research-validated): eleven_v4 is $0.08/1k chars billed per-API only; the Starter subscription covers the jam month's volume with margin. No runtime TTS, no API keys in the client — everything ships pre-baked.

3 · Milestone-aware view (what each funded milestone delivers)

Milestone	Delivered in the jam build	Next, with funding
M1 · Playable prototype	Four chapters + finale end-to-end; one persistent stall screen; 48 passing tests; edge cases (zero/partial/negative/rounding) covered	Balance pass 2 (more run seeds), fresh-eyes playtest report
M2 · Learning system	Decision ledger → debrief → Irrationality Profile → Cost-of-Not-Acting, all pure functions over recorded choices; no trap labelled in play	Ch.4 (a fourth bias, scope-guarded), debrief A/B on line-item vs counterfactual framing
M3 · Presentation & access	Street scene with lit/shut states, baked voices, simple-language mode, keyboard-complete, colourblind-safe	Souq Mode (AED + Gulf framing; stretch: Arabic subs), 1080p trailer, iOS Safari pass
M4 · Distribution	itch.io package (private until submission); concept doc + this budget + 2-minute gameplay video	Public publish post-jam; shareable Irrationality Profile card; Sikizana funnel CTA

4 · Scope discipline (why the budget stays small)

The jam build was deliberately cut to three biases deep (present bias + anchoring primary, sunk cost supporting), two mascots as pixel SVG rather than commissioned layered portraits, and a single persistent screen instead of five scenes. The post-jam roadmap (Jan 7 Chroma) is where the optional $300–450 illustration push and the Souq Mode spend would land — each behind a named milestone, not assumed.

> Regulatory note: the budget funds no user data, no third-party processing of personal data, and no paid distribution. The game's ledger is browser-local and clearable; all AI-generated material is disclosed to judges and on the itch page.